SLL-2 Ground & Match Services Agreement - Essex Farms (Draft)

Nov 8, 2026 · @Nikster

Drafting notes (remove before signing)

This is a first draft for counsel to review; it is not legal advice. Essex Farms gets one fixed rate per match day for a turnkey package: the ground, prepared pitch and outfield, umpires, scorers, match balls, ground staff, power and lights, and basic facilities. The League pays one invoice per weekend and holds back 10%, so a missed service costs the venue money automatically. That fixes the Season 1 problems: SportsCube billed match by match, balls came from a separate vendor, and the tent bill swung from ₹49,500 to ₹1,84,360 a weekend.

The budget allows **₹79,000 a match day** (ground hire 40,000, umpires 18,000, scorers 5,000, ball boys and ground staff 5,000, generator and diesel 11,000). It also allows **₹2,00,000** for pitch and outfield preparation and about **₹550 a ball**. Season 1's SportsCube contract came to about ₹50,000 a match day.

Open points

- [ ] **Rates:** Essex Farms' quote against the rate card in Schedule 3. The target is at or below the budget.
- [ ] **Season shape:** 33 matches over 12 match days is the working plan for 12 teams. The 3 Nov calendar (every weekend from 23 Jan to 14 Mar) needs the venue held for more days. Both are drafted as "reserved days" plus "confirmed match days".
- [ ] **Umpire panel:** does Essex Farms supply its own panel, or does the League appoint umpires whom the venue pays? Drafted as the venue supplying them, with the League able to veto names.
- [ ] **Ball brand and model** (white ball, Rule 1.2): [•]. Two new balls per match (one per innings) plus spares.
- [ ] **Floodlights:** is the 3:00 PM slot a day-night match needing lights? Drafted as lights and generator included.
- [ ] **DRS:** Rule 10.4 gives each team 2 reviews. That needs replay feeds from the broadcaster, not the venue. Confirm with the stream crew.
- [ ] **For counsel:** Essex Farms' legal entity, address, GST and authorised signatory; the League's details; stamp duty.

Ground and Match Services Agreement

This Agreement is made at New Delhi on [date] between:

1. **Playful Ventures Private Limited**, CIN [•], registered office [•], acting through [name, designation] (the **League**); and
2. **[Legal entity operating Essex Farms Cricket Club & Academy]**, [constitution], registered office [•], GSTIN [•], acting through [name, designation] (the **Venue Provider**), which operates the cricket ground known as Essex Farms Cricket Club & Academy, near Shokeen International School, Chhawla, New Delhi 110071 (the **Ground**).

Recitals

A. The League organises the Shanti Devi Legends League, a corporate T20 league. Its second season (**SLL-2**) runs from 23 January to 14 March 2027.

B. The Venue Provider owns or lawfully controls the Ground. It has agreed to host every SLL-2 match there and to provide the match services in this Agreement for a fixed fee per match day.

1. Definitions

- **Match Day** means a day on which one or more SLL-2 matches are scheduled at the Ground, normally a Saturday or Sunday.
- **Reserved Days** means the days listed in Schedule 1 that the Venue Provider holds for the League. **Confirmed Match Days** are the Reserved Days the League confirms under clause 2.3.
- **Slots** means the three match slots on a Match Day, with reporting times of 8:00 AM, 11:30 AM and 3:00 PM IST (Rule 4.2), each match lasting about 3 hours 30 minutes.
- **Match Services** means the services in clause 3 and Schedule 2.
- **Rules** means the SLL-2 Rules & Regulations issued by the League (3 November 2026), as amended.
- **League Representative** means the person the League names in writing to act for it on Match Days, initially [name, mobile].
- **Fee** means the amounts in Schedule 3.

2. Use of the Ground

2.1 The Venue Provider grants the League exclusive use of the Ground, its pavilion, dressing rooms and the facilities in Schedule 2, Part A. This runs on every Confirmed Match Day from **6:30 AM until one hour after the last match ends** (and no later than

[11:00 PM]).

2.2 **Exclusivity.** On Confirmed Match Days the Venue Provider shall not book the Ground, nets next to the field of play, or the parking area for any other event, practice or match. On Reserved Days that are not yet confirmed, it shall not book the Ground without first offering the day to the League, which has 48 hours to confirm.

2.3 **Confirming days.** The League shall confirm the Match Days and the Slots used on each by [15 December 2026], after the SLL-2 auction, by sending the fixture list. It may change a Confirmed Match Day on 7 days' written notice without charge, at most [3] times in the season. It may also add Reserved Days for semi-finals, a final or a replayed match.

2.4 **Additional days.** The League may book extra days at the Ground (practice, trials, a media day) at the rate in Schedule 3, subject to availability.

2.5 **Access before the season.** The Venue Provider shall give the League and its vendors reasonable access, by appointment, to survey the Ground. This covers a broadcast survey, branding measurements and tent layout, and a test day for the live stream before the first Match Day.

2.6 **Condition.** The Venue Provider confirms that the Ground is a turf ground fit for T20 cricket under standard ICC playing conditions. It holds every licence, permission and approval needed to host the matches, spectators, broadcast and catering, and it will keep them valid throughout the season.

3. Match Services

The Venue Provider shall provide the following on every Confirmed Match Day, at its own cost and within the Fee. The service standards are in Schedule 4.

3.1 **Pitch and outfield.**

- (a) A prepared turf pitch fit for T20 cricket for each match. Pitches are rotated so that no pitch is used for more than [2] matches on one day.
- (b) The outfield mown and rolled, free of stones and hazards, with the 30-yard circle, creases and fielding markings freshly painted before the first match. Creases are re-marked and the pitch swept and rolled (light roller, up to 7 minutes) between matches.
- (c) A boundary of [60–65] metres from the centre of the pitch, marked by rope or cushions.
- (d) Covers for the pitch and square, and the staff and equipment to cover and dry the ground quickly when it rains (super-sopper or equivalent).
- (e) Sight-screens at both ends, three sets of stumps and bails (one in use, two spare), a drinks trolley, and a working rope or pole for every boundary.

- (f) Pitch preparation to begin at least [10] days before the first Match Day, with a pitch report to the League 48 hours before each Match Day.

3.2 **Umpires and match officials.**

- (a) Two qualified on-field umpires for every match, plus one reserve (third) umpire for each Match Day who also handles DRS reviews when replay is available (Rule 10.4).
- (b) Umpires must hold [a DDCA / BCCI-recognised panel certification or level [•]], know the Rules (including the Legend scoring in Rule 8, powerplays and the over-rate rules), and wear a uniform the League approves.
- (c) The Venue Provider shall send the League its umpire panel by [1 January 2027]. The League may reject any umpire on reasonable grounds, including any link to a franchise, owner or player. No umpire may stand in a match involving a team they have played for, owned or been paid by.
- (d) Umpires report 45 minutes before the first reporting time and stay until the last match's result is signed.
- (e) [The match referee is appointed by the League / is supplied by the Venue Provider: choose one.]

3.3 **Scorers.** One official scorer per match, scoring ball by ball live on the League's digital platform (Rule 1.7). Also one backup paper scorer per Match Day. The signed scorecard goes to the League Representative within 30 minutes of each match. Scorers shall follow the League's scoring guide for Legend runs and the Impact Player.

3.4 **Match balls.**

- (a) White balls of [brand and model], approved by the League (Rule 1.2). Two new balls for every match, one per innings, opened in front of the umpires.
- (b) A box of at least [6] used replacement balls of similar wear on each Match Day, kept by the reserve umpire.
- (c) The Venue Provider shall stock at least [100] balls by the first Match Day and top up the stock so it never falls below [24].
- (d) Used match balls belong to the League. [Option: the League may supply the balls itself, in which case the Fee is reduced by the ball rate in Schedule 3.]

3.5 **Ground staff.** At least [4] ground staff, [2] ball boys and [2] housekeeping staff for the pavilion and washrooms throughout each Match Day. All of them wear identification and follow the League Representative's reasonable directions.

3.6 **Power and lights.** Mains power with a standby generator and enough diesel to run the floodlights, broadcast, public address, tent and catering through every match without a break. Power for the broadcast is [•] kVA, from a dedicated circuit. If the 3:00 PM match

runs past sunset, the floodlights must give at least [•] lux and be on before visibility drops.

3.7 **Venue coordinator.** One named person on site with authority to act for the Venue Provider, from 6:30 AM until the Ground is handed back. Named in Schedule 1.

4. The League's responsibilities

4.1 The League shall:

- (a) send the fixture list and Slots under clause 2.3, and any change as early as practicable;
- (b) organise the teams, players, match referee (if under clause 3.2(e)), broadcast, catering, tent and seating, public address, branding and the League's own match-day staff;
- (c) name a League Representative for each Match Day, who signs the match-day checklist in Schedule 4;
- (d) make sure its teams, vendors and guests follow the Ground's reasonable rules on safety, smoking, alcohol and restricted areas (Schedule 2, Part B), and use only the designated changing rooms (Rule 7.5); and
- (e) leave the Ground in the condition it was received, fair wear and tear excepted, and pay for damage caused by its teams, vendors or guests.

4.2 The League's on-field decisions (through its match referee and the Organising Committee) govern the cricket. The Venue Provider's staff shall not interfere with them.

5. Broadcast, branding and commercial rights

5.1 All broadcast, streaming, photography, video, data and ball-by-ball clip rights in SLL-2 matches belong to the League. The Venue Provider shall allow the League's broadcaster to set up camera positions, cabling, a commentary box and a production area as agreed in the venue survey (clause 2.5). It shall not record or stream matches itself.

5.2 On Confirmed Match Days the League has the exclusive right to branding at the Ground. That includes boundary boards, sight-screens, pitch-side wedges, the scorer's box, dugouts and entrances, and the stumps if the League supplies branded stumps. The Venue Provider shall cover or remove other third-party branding in the broadcast frame [except its own name board at the entrance].

5.3 The Venue Provider is named as **Venue Partner** of SLL-2 on the League's website, broadcast graphics and Venue Partner logo positions, as the League decides. The League may use the Ground's name, images and logo for that purpose during and after the season.

5.4 Catering, merchandise and hospitality on Confirmed Match Days are the League's. The Venue Provider may run its own canteen only with the League's prior consent, and it may not sell or advertise brands that compete with League sponsors.

6. Fees and payment

6.1 **Fee.** For each Confirmed Match Day the League shall pay the Match Day fee in Schedule 3. It covers everything in clauses 2 and 3: ground, umpires, scorers, ground staff, ball boys, housekeeping, power, generator and diesel, and lights. In addition the League shall pay the one-time pitch and outfield preparation fee and the ball charge in Schedule 3. No other charge is payable unless the League has agreed it in writing in advance.

6.2 **Days not used.** No fee is payable for a Reserved Day that is not confirmed. If the League cancels a Confirmed Match Day with less than 7 days' notice, other than for weather or force majeure, it shall pay [50]% of the Match Day fee.

6.3 **Advance.** On signing, the League shall pay an advance of [10]% of the estimated season fee (Schedule 3). The advance is adjusted against the first invoices.

6.4 **Invoices.** The Venue Provider shall invoice after each weekend for the Confirmed Match Days played, with the signed match-day checklists (Schedule 4) attached. The League shall pay undisputed amounts within [15] days of receiving a valid GST tax invoice, by bank transfer only. No cash payments.

6.5 **Retention.** The League shall hold back 10% of each invoice. The retention is released within 30 days after the final match, once the Ground is handed back and all service credits have been settled.

6.6 **Service credits.** If a service falls short of the standard in Schedule 4, the League may deduct the service credit shown there from the next invoice or from the retention. Service credits are the League's main remedy for routine shortfalls, but they do not limit its rights for a serious or repeated failure (clause 7.6).

6.7 **Taxes.** Fees are exclusive of GST, which the League shall pay against a valid tax invoice. The League may deduct tax at source as required by law.

6.8 The Venue Provider is solely responsible for paying its own staff, umpires, scorers and suppliers, and for all statutory dues relating to them. Umpires and scorers shall not seek or accept any payment from franchises, owners or players.

7. Safety, risk, weather and termination

7.1 **Safety and medical.** The Venue Provider shall keep the Ground, stands, structures, electrical installations and washrooms safe and in good repair. It shall provide a first-aid room, a staff member trained in first aid on every Match Day, and a clear route for an

ambulance to the field of play. The League arranges the ambulance and medical cover. The Venue Provider shall also provide fire extinguishers and keep emergency exits clear.

7.2 **Security.** The Venue Provider controls the Ground's gates and perimeter and keeps its property secure overnight, including any League equipment left at the Ground by agreement. The League provides event security inside the venue on Match Days.

7.3 **Insurance.** The Venue Provider shall hold public liability insurance of at least INR [•] for the Ground for the whole season, with the League named as an additional insured. It shall show proof before the first Match Day. The League shall hold [event / public liability] insurance for SLL-2 matches.

7.4 **Liability.** Each Party indemnifies the other against third-party claims for death, injury or damage to property caused by its own negligence or breach, or that of its staff and contractors. Apart from that indemnity, and except for fraud, neither Party is liable for indirect or consequential loss. Each Party's total liability is limited to the total season fee under this Agreement.

7.5 **Weather and an unfit ground.**

- (a) The umpires, with the match referee, decide whether play is possible (Rules 10.11 and 11). The Venue Provider shall use all its ground staff and equipment to get the Ground fit for play as fast as possible.
- (b) If no ball is bowled on a Confirmed Match Day because of weather, [50]% of the Match Day fee is payable. If any match starts, the full fee is payable.
- (c) If the Ground is unfit for a reason within the Venue Provider's control (pitch not prepared, covers not used, waterlogging, power failure, umpires absent), no fee is payable for the matches lost. The Venue Provider shall also give the League a replacement day at no charge and pay the service credits in Schedule 4.

7.6 **Termination by the League.** The League may terminate this Agreement by written notice if: (a) the Ground becomes unavailable or loses a licence it needs; (b) a critical failure (Schedule 4) occurs on two Match Days; or (c) the Venue Provider commits any other material breach and does not remedy it within 3 days of notice. The League may then move the remaining matches to another ground. The Venue Provider shall reimburse the reasonable extra cost of that ground, up to INR [•], and the League may set it off against any amount due.

7.7 **Termination by the Venue Provider.** The Venue Provider may terminate only if an undisputed invoice remains unpaid 30 days after written notice. It shall not suspend services during the season while that notice runs.

7.8 **Force majeure.** Neither Party is liable for failure caused by events beyond its reasonable control, such as government orders, epidemics, civil unrest, national mourning or extreme weather beyond clause 7.5. The Parties shall reschedule affected Match Days

in good faith, and no fee is payable for days not played.

8. Term, disputes and general

8.1 **Term.** This Agreement runs from signing until the retention is released after the SLL-2 final, unless terminated earlier. [Option: the Venue Provider grants the League a right of first refusal on the same dates for SLL-3, to be exercised by 30 June 2027.]

8.2 **Conduct and integrity.** The Venue Provider's staff, umpires and scorers shall not bet on, or help anyone bet on, SLL-2 matches. They shall not pass on match information for that purpose, or accept gifts from franchises, owners or players. Any breach is a material breach.

8.3 **Confidentiality.** Each Party keeps the terms of this Agreement and the other's non-public information confidential, except as required by law or to advisers.

8.4 **Disputes.** The League Representative and the venue coordinator settle match-day issues on the spot. Any other dispute goes first to a meeting between senior representatives within 7 days of a written request. If it is not resolved within 21 days, it shall be referred to a sole arbitrator under the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996. The seat is New Delhi and the language English. The courts at New Delhi have exclusive jurisdiction.

8.5 **General.** This Agreement (with its Schedules) is the entire agreement on its subject. It may be changed only in writing signed by both Parties. Neither Party may assign it without the other's consent, except that the League may assign it to an affiliate or successor organiser of the league. Nothing in it creates a partnership or employment. Notices go by email to the addresses in Schedule 1, with a courier copy for breach or termination. It may be signed electronically and in counterparts. Stamp duty: [counsel].

Execution

For the League	For the Venue Provider
Playful Ventures Private Limited	**[Venue Provider]**
Name: [•]	Name: [•]
Designation: [•]	Designation: [•]
Signature: _____	Signature: _____
Date: [•]	Date: [•]

Witnesses: 1. [name, address, signature] · 2. [name, address, signature]

Schedule 1: Dates and contacts

Reserved Days: every Saturday and Sunday from 23 January to 14 March 2027, 16 days: 23–24 Jan, 30–31 Jan, 6–7 Feb, 13–14 Feb, 20–21 Feb, 27–28 Feb, 6–7 Mar, 13–14 Mar. The League expects to confirm about **12 Match Days** (33 matches for 12 teams), including the semi-finals and final on 13–14 March. Slots each day: reporting at 8:00 AM, 11:30 AM and 3:00 PM.

Role	League	Venue Provider
Signatory	[•]	[•]
Match-day representative / venue coordinator	[name, mobile]	[name, mobile]
Accounts (invoices)	[email]	[email]

Schedule 2: Facilities and ground rules

Part A: Facilities on every Match Day

- Two dressing rooms with changing areas, one per team, plus a separate umpires' room
- Clean washrooms (men and women) with running water, and drinking water for players and staff
- Two covered dugouts with seating for at least [15] each
- A scorer's box with power and a table, and a commentary or production position for the broadcaster
- Parking for at least [•] cars, and access for the broadcast van, tent vendor and caterer
- Space next to the boundary for the League's tent, seating and catering ([•] square metres)
- A first-aid room, and an ambulance route to the field of play
- Mains power plus a standby generator; floodlights for the 3:00 PM match [if required]

Part B: Ground rules for the League's teams and vendors: [Venue Provider to list: smoking, alcohol, restricted areas, vehicle movement, waste disposal].

Schedule 3: Fees

Item	Unit	Budget planning rate (₹)	Agreed rate (₹)	Estimated quantity	Estimated total (₹)
Match Day fee: ground hire, umpires, scorers, ground staff and ball boys, power, generator and diesel, lights	per Confirmed Match Day	79,000	[•]	12	9,48,000
Pitch and outfield preparation	one-time	2,00,000	[•]	1	2,00,000
Match balls ([brand, model])	per ball	550	[•]	100	55,000
Additional day (practice, trials, media)	per day	—	[•]	as booked	—
Estimated season total (before GST)					**12,03,000**

The planning rate breaks down as: ground hire 40,000, umpires 18,000, scorers 5,000, ball boys and ground staff 5,000, generator and diesel 11,000 per Match Day. The advance under clause 6.3 is 10% of the estimated season total.

Schedule 4: Service standards and service credits

The League Representative and the venue coordinator complete and sign this checklist at the end of each Match Day. A **critical failure** is any venue-caused shortfall that stops a match starting within 30 minutes of its scheduled time, or causes it to be abandoned.

Service	Standard	Service credit if missed (₹)
Ground ready	Pitch, markings, boundary, sight-screens and stumps ready by 7:30 AM	5,000 per 15 minutes of delay to the first match
Umpires	2 on-field umpires per match and 1 reserve per day, on time and in uniform	5,000 per missing umpire per match
Scorers	Every ball scored live on the League's platform; signed scorecard within 30 minutes	2,000 per match

Service	Standard	Service credit if missed (₹)
Match balls	2 new approved balls per match + at least 6 spares on the day	2,000 per ball short
Power and lights	No outage longer than 10 minutes during a match	5,000 per outage
Ground staff	At least 4 ground staff, 2 ball boys, 2 housekeeping	1,000 per person short per day
Washrooms and water	Clean and stocked throughout the day	2,000 per day
Critical failure	None	No fee for the matches lost + 25,000 per match; counts towards termination (clause 7.6)